2. In absolute term (National)	–	301.7 million
i) Rural	–	220.9 million
ii) Urban	–	80.8 million

Different Approaches to Poverty Estimation

The above approach is called **subsistence approach**. It focuses on the individual level and measures whether the individuals are able to meet their physiological needs namely food, *pan* (betel leaves), tobacco, intoxicants and fuel & light, clothing and footwear and miscellaneous goods and services and durable articles. The subsistence is the state or fact of existing. The *Oxford Dictionary* defines subsistence level as 'A standard of living (or wage) that provides only the bare necessities of life'[1]. The people who could not afford even the bare necessities of life are called poor. The subsistence approach is uni-dimensional.

A higher level approach is **basic needs approach**. It is relatively wider than the subsistence approach. It focuses not only on individual level but also on community level. It necessitates provision of amenities and services like sanitation, education, healthcare etc. at community level and those who lack these facilities are considered poor. This approach is multi-dimensional.

The **relative deprivation approach** look at poverty at a broader level compared to the two previous approaches. It is wider than the above two concepts and measures deprivation an individual or a group face compared to others. It goes beyond physical and basic needs and specially focuses on social inequality. Social exclusion also considered in this approach. It is one of the measures of relative poverty. This approach is also multi-dimensional.

These three approaches to poverty are represented graphically reflecting their scope.